

Zero to One — Executive Founder Guide

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The Contrarian Question:

"What important truth do very few people agree with you on?"

Repairo's Truth: API maintenance doesn't require human developers fixing code manually—it can be 100% automated in volatile RAM via AST rewrites.

1. Vertical Progress (0 to 1) vs Horizontal Progress (1 to N)

- **1 to N (Globalization):** Copying things that work (building another wrapper or dashboard).
- **0 to 1 (Technology):** Doing something brand new (building an automated AST repair engine).

2. Characteristics of a Monopoly (The 4 Pillars)

- **1. Proprietary Technology:** Must be 10x better than the next best alternative in some important dimension.
- **2. Network Effects:** Product becomes more valuable as more engineers use it.
- **3. Economies of Scale:** High fixed cost upfront, near-zero marginal cost per additional code repair.
- **4. Branding:** Establishing a strong brand presence early (like Stripe, Vercel, Linear).

3. The 7 Questions Every Startup Must Answer

- **1. The Engineering Question:** Can you create breakthrough technology instead of incremental improvements?
- **2. The Timing Question:** Is now the right time to start your company?
- **3. The Monopoly Question:** Are you starting with a big share of a small market?
- **4. The People Question:** Do you have the right team?
- **5. The Distribution Question:** Do you have a way to not just create but deliver your product?
- **6. The Durability Question:** Will your market position be defensible 10 to 20 years in the future?
- **7. The Secret Question:** Have you identified a unique opportunity that others don't see?